

New Clues Change the Picture of T. Rex

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Scientists keep learning new things about **Tyrannosaurus rex**. Early pictures showed a slow swamp dinosaur with a dragging tail. Newer ideas show a more active animal that may have been **warm-blooded** and possibly had **feathers**.

Its tiny arms were a long puzzle. **Fossils** show T. rex had two fingers. A study says small arms left room for a huge, strong head and neck **muscles**.

Some research says lips may have covered its teeth when its mouth was closed. That is different from many movie pictures with teeth always showing.

T. rex was probably not a fast long-distance runner. Estimates put its top speed near 12 miles per hour. It may have used short bursts to hunt and also eaten large dead animals. Scientists still study how much food it needed.

Word Treasure

Tyrannosaurus rex -- A famous large meat-eating dinosaur from long ago.

Fossils -- Ancient bones and other remains preserved in rock.

warm-blooded -- Able to keep a steadier body temperature using inner energy.

feathers -- Light coverings; scientists say T. rex may have had some.

muscles -- Body parts that pull to create movement and strength.

Background you need

Scientists study dinosaur fossils to learn how extinct animals looked and lived. Ideas about famous dinosaurs change when new fossils and studies appear. T. rex is one of the best-known predators from the age of dinosaurs.

Break it down

WHO: Scientists studying Tyrannosaurus rex

WHAT: New clues change how we picture T. rex

WHERE: In fossils and research studies

WHY: To understand how this famous dinosaur really lived

Why it matters

Dinosaur updates show that science keeps improving old pictures with better evidence.

Test what you remember

1. How many fingers do fossils show on T. rex hands?
 - (A) Ten
 - (B) None
 - (C) Two
 - (D) Five
2. About what top speed does the article mention?
 - (A) 100 miles per hour
 - (B) 60 miles per hour
 - (C) Near 12 miles per hour
 - (D) 2 miles per hour
3. What might have covered T. rex teeth when its mouth was closed?
 - (A) Metal armor
 - (B) Ice
 - (C) Plastic
 - (D) Lips
4. What did early pictures often show?
 - (A) A radio host
 - (B) A flying fish
 - (C) A bike helmet
 - (D) A slow swamp dinosaur with a dragging tail
5. What might newer ideas say about its body temperature?
 - (A) It may have been warm-blooded
 - (B) It never ate
 - (C) It lived only in cities
 - (D) It was made of ice
6. Why might small arms have helped?
 - (A) They played harp
 - (B) They held phones
 - (C) They left room for a huge strong head
 - (D) They steered bikes

Answer key (try the quiz first!): 1: C 2: C 3: D 4: D 5: A 6: C

MY THOUGHTS (at least 20 words):